Abdullah Al Zahid

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Talent Acquisition
Aecon Civil
Aecon Group Inc., Toronto, ON

Re: Traffic Lead

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to apply for the Traffic Lead position with Aecon Civil. I am an Assistant Planner in Transportation Planning at the City of Toronto, and before that I worked in GO rail service design at Metrolinx and at Mott MacDonald, where I worked on Ontario Line construction staging.

At Mott MacDonald I ran Synchro traffic simulations to estimate how Ontario Line construction staging and road closures would affect surrounding streets, and prepared the supporting material for the project team. At Metrolinx I assessed the service effect of temporary and permanent slow orders, the kind of restriction construction on an operating railway imposes. I also set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.

At the City I review development applications and the transportation studies filed with them against City standards, and I coordinate with divisions, consultants, applicants and outside agencies whose priorities conflict. The posting asks for experience with the City of Toronto and Metrolinx, and I have worked for both.

I should be straightforward about the gaps. The posting asks for eight years in urban traffic operations; I have about four and a half years in transportation planning, and my traffic work has been simulation and review rather than operations in the field. I have not prepared traffic control plans to OTM Book 7, Traffic and Transit Management Plans or lane closure reports, or recommended signal timing changes, and I do not hold a Class G licence, which the posting requires.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Abdullah Al Zahid

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